

Pull Me Under -- Dream Theater

Images and Words, 1992. ~116 BPM, est.

DT's biggest radio hit -- driving verse groove, big anthemic chorus, and a heavier mid-song instrumental break before the final chorus. John Myung's part underneath all of it is full, modern, and precise -- not a vintage tone. GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

NAM: Mesa M-Pulse Big Block 750

Mesa M-Pulse Big Block 750 Bass Head (2004), Clean Channel -> Peavey 215 Enclosure (1986). Slot 70. This capture gives a modern, full-range clean bass tone with real headroom -- exactly what a part this precise needs. It stays composed under the driving verse and still has room to take a push in the instrumental section without breaking up on its own; that push comes from DST instead (see below), not from overdriving the amp. AMP and CAB are off -- the NAM replaces both.

- Gain: 40 -- clean and controlled, not edge-of-breakup. This amp isn't the drive source in this patch.
- VOL: 72
- Bass: 65 -- full low end to anchor the driving 8th-note verse groove.
- Middle: 55 -- enough to cut through the guitar layers without honking.
- Treble: 52 -- present pick/finger attack, not brittle.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 30. Keeps the low end tight between phrases at this level of clarity -- nothing sustains longer than the part calls for.

PRE -- off.

No boost stage. The Mesa capture already has the headroom this patch needs; a boost here would just push the amp into territory it's not voiced for.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 55, Blend: 70, VOL: 65, Bass: 60, Treble: 50 when engaged.

Off for the main verse/chorus groove. On for the heavier instrumental section -- adds real grit and push without needing to touch the NAM's own gain staging, and blends back to keep the note fundamental intact under the grind.

AMP / CAB -- off. Replaced by the NAM.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +3, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: -3, 800Hz: -2, 4.5kHz: +4, VOL: 55.

Small low-end reinforcement, a cut through the low-mids to stop the Mesa capture from getting boxy against the guitars, and a lift at 4.5kHz so fast picked/finger passages read clearly instead of blurring together.

MOD -- off. Straight, driving part -- no modulation.

DLY -- off. No delay. This part needs to sit tight in the pocket, not trail behind itself.

RVB -- Room, on CTL.

Mix: 22, Decay: 35, Trail: true.

Off for the main groove -- dry and direct. On with the DST for the instrumental section -- a touch of room widens the sound to match the bigger, heavier arrangement without turning it into a wash.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: DST (Bass OD) and RVB (Room).

- **CTL off** -- main verse/chorus groove. Clean Mesa tone, dry and tight, driving the song forward. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- heavier instrumental section. Adds grit from the Bass OD and a touch of room, same core amp tone, bigger and pushier for the breakdown before the final chorus.

Engage CTL going into the instrumental section, back off once the final chorus/outro settles back into the main groove.